

Boot Code

The program recorded in a boot sector is known as boot code. Boot sectors usually contain boot code because these small programs have the job of starting to load a PC's operating system once the BIOS completes its POST checks.

Boot Infector, Boot Sector Infector, BSI

A boot sector infector virus places its starting code in the boot sector. When the computer tries to read and execute the program in the boot sector, the virus is loaded into the memory, where it can gain control over basic computer operations. From the memory, a boot sector infector can spread to other drives (floppy, network etc.) on the system. Once the virus is running, it usually executes the normal boot program, which it stores elsewhere on the disk.

Boot Record

The program recorded in the boot sector. This record contains information on the characteristics and contents of the disk and information needed to boot the computer. If a user boots a PC with a floppy disk, the system reads the boot record from that disk.

Boot Sector

An area located on the first track of floppy disks and logical disks that contain the boot record. Boot sector usually refers to this specific sector of a floppy disk, whereas the term Master Boot Sector usually refers to the same section of a hard disk. See Also: Master Boot Record

Boot Virus

A virus that infects boot sectors. Also, refer to Boot Sector Infector for more details.

Bug

An unintentional fault in a program that causes actions neither the user nor the program author intended.